



Ellis *Fairweather*

FAMILY DOCTOR

*“Knows every heartbeat in Fernley,
and every secret that comes with it.”*



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A dark waistcoat or a tidy cardigan, a pocket watch on a chain, spectacles if you have them, and a battered leather doctor's bag (any handbag will do).

At the table you are: calm, precise and never quite off duty.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

Your story

You have been Barty's doctor for twenty years and you check Barty's heart every Saturday at five. Tonight it was as steady as a church clock. Barty had promised £1,000 for a new wing at Fernley Cottage Hospital, your life's work.

YOUR SECRET

At the five o'clock checkup Barty said the hospital money must wait: "The Trust money has gone astray, and I mean to find out where by Monday." You were bitterly disappointed and said something sharp. Worse, Dormital, a sleeping powder, is a medicine you prescribe, so eyes may turn to you.

Where you were

5:00 - 5:15	In the study, checking Barty's heart.
5:15 - 5:40	A walk on the terrace, then in to the drawing-room fire.
5:45 - 6:30	By the drawing-room fire, listening to Rowan play the piano. Neither of you left.
6:30	Sherry in the drawing room.
6:45	Morgan called you to the study. You could not wake Barty.

Your goal tonight

Show that the sleeping powder did not come from your bag. Find out who has been dipping into the Trust. Keep the hospital quarrel quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you...

"Was Barty ill?" "A weak heart, well looked after. Barty would have seen ninety."

"What happened to Barty?" "Barty fell into a very deep sleep and never woke. Something in that glass did it."

"Do you carry sleeping powders?" "Never. My bag holds a stethoscope, heart drops and peppermints. Look for yourself."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Ellis Fairweather • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS

- **MUST SHARE** From a quarter to six until the sherry at half past six, I sat by the drawing-room fire while Rowan played the piano. Neither of us left the room.
- Barty's heart was steady at five o'clock. This was no natural turn.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “Who poured Barty’s cordial tonight, and when?”
- **Sage:** “You came for a meeting before supper. Did it end happily?”

YOUR TASK Ask everyone at the table when they last saw Barty, and jot each time in your notes.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • **MUST SHARE** Dormital is a sleeping powder I prescribe. One sachet gives a gentle night's sleep. Two at once, on top of Barty's heart drops, would be far too strong. At this table I have prescribed it to one person only: Sage. I wrote the prescription yesterday.

- My bag holds no Dormital at all. Anyone may look.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “That torn check has your name on it. What happened in the study?”
- **Sage:** “How many Dormital sachets do you have with you tonight?”

YOUR TASK Hold up your doctor's bag (or any bag) and invite the table to look inside.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Ellis Fairweather • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- **MUST SHARE** At five o'clock Barty told me the hospital money must wait: "The Trust money has gone astray, and I mean to find out where by Monday."
- I was angry and I said so. But I wanted that wing built with Barty's blessing, not out of Barty's will.

ASK

- **Sage:** “As trustee, what were you going to tell Barty’s new lawyers on Monday?”
- **Morgan:** “Did anyone go near the study between six and half past six?”

YOUR TASK

Compare Evidence #4 and #7 aloud and count the sachets for the table.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef